RSS Digest
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1. dbreunig/nesformer
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-30T21:59:22+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/30/nesformer/
dbreunig/nesformer Inspired by qwenputer by Divyansh Agrawal, Drew Breunig baked a working emulator for a Nintendo Entertainment System 6502 CPU into the weights of Qwen3.5-4B. You can now play NES ROMs such as Super Mario Bros (very slowly) running inside Qwen! In a comment on Hacker News Drew reveals the Opus 5.5 prompts he used to build this system: Read this article and any relevant source code: https://divagr.com/blog/qwenputer. Then explore if you could emulate the chip and ram in a Nintendo Entertainment System (as people do today with FPGAs in MISTRs) using this technique. If so, what size model would you have to build and if you could use smaller faster ones, could you get it to be at the standard clockspeed. Followed by: I think we should build it! Just for fun. It’s okay if it’s not fast. We want to be able to have the weights, and a cli to run them that we can point at a ROM. Apparently Opus found and then used this collection of conformance tests for the NES CPU released 15 years ago by Christopher Pow. Via Hacker News Tags: games , ai , generative-ai , llms , drew-breunig , qwen , conformance-suites

2. Quoting Terk Terkowitz
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-28T10:09:07+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/28/terk-terkowitz/
If your work does not benefit from current AI tooling, that is a finding, not a failing. Document why, share it with your community of peers, bring it to your manager, and work to find solutions. An engineer who can explain where AI does not yet help their work is demonstrating the judgement we are asking for. ? Terk Terkowitz , An update from Amazon engineering leadership on the role of the developer in the age of AI Tags: amazon , generative-ai , agentic-engineering , ai , llms

3. Rejoice, leap seconds are dead!
Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Fri, 30 Oct 2026 09:00:00 -0500
Link: https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/rejoice-the-utc-leap-second-is-dead/
There will never be a leap second again. At least not for UTC. At the CGPM , they decided the last leap second we’ll ever see for UTC, or Coordinated Universal Time, happened back at the end of 2016 . Of course they made that decision while I was out on vacation, so I’m just getting this video up now: .embed-container { position: relative; padding-bottom: 56.25%; height: 0; overflow: hidden; max-width: 100%; } .embed-container iframe, .embed-container object, .embed-container embed { position: absolute; top: 0; left: 0; width: 100%; height: 100%; } But what’s the CGPM, why does this matter, and why am I excited about it?

4. Sponsorship Openings for Daring Fireball (Including The Talk Show)
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-30T22:30:54Z
Link: https://daringfireball.net/feeds/sponsors/
Sponsorships have continued selling briskly, of late . Knock on wood. As of yesterday, the next opening on the schedule wasn?t until the last week of December, and the Q1 2027 schedule is already filling up. However, due to some schedule rejiggering, next week is now open. If you?ve got a product or service you think would be of interest to DF?s audience of people obsessed with high quality and good design, just email me ? especially if you can act quick for next week?s opening. I?m also booking sponsorships for Q1 and Q2 2027, and over half of those weeks are already sold. The rate for the two remaining weeks in 2026 is $11,000, and the rate for open weeks in 2027 is $12,500. The sponsorship schedule for The Talk Show also has openings, including for the next few episodes in November and December. The general rule of thumb is that sponsorship spots on The Talk Show cost one-third the rate for the weekly spots on DF. I?m happy to work out deals a little lower than that for first-time sponsors. If you?ve got a

product or service you?d like to hear pitched on America?s favorite three-star podcast, get in touch . ?

5. ? MacBook Pro Pricing and Configurations for M6, M5 Pro, and M5 Max
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-30T21:56:10Z
Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/10/macbook_pro_pricing_and_configurations_for_m6_m5_pro_and_m5_max
I find it useful to organize all of the configuration options into tables on a single page, and I figured it might be useful to share this now, before I finish writing my full thoughts on the redesigned hardware and displays for the PROLED XDR models.

6. The Only Good Easter Eggs Are Whole-Assed Easter Eggs
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-30T17:53:41Z
Link: https://unsung.aresluna.org/apples-ipod-recreation/
Marcin Wichary on the original iPod easter egg on Apple Music?s website 404 page: I am usually not a fan of easter eggs ? most of them are poorly made ? but this might be the best iPod recreation I?ve seen, and it?s an interesting thing to study: I think it generally covers all the modes etc. (with small exceptions) the typography looks accurate, it has the little ?haptic? beeps, it has proper acceleration and the scrollbar, it has a little music library with various playlists, I have only noticed a few small bugs. It looks real, sounds real, feels real. Don?t bother with your easter egg idea if you?re going to half-ass it. ?

7. Elegance and intelligence are anticorrelated
Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Fri, 30 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://seangoedecke.com/elegance-and-intelligence-are-anticorrelated/
Elegance and intelligence can have a surprisingly negative correlation. Intelligent people sometimes produce inelegant solutions because they?re capable of rapidly brute-forcing problems. If I had to remember a hundred names, I would spend time coming up with clever mnemonics. John von Neumann would probably just remember them. There?s a famous von Neumann story where he was asked how far a fly must travel if it kept flying between two cyclists who were approaching each other at some fixed speed. The trick to the puzzle was to notice that the cyclists would take an hour to meet, so the fly must be travelling for an hour: given the fly?s speed, it?s then easy to calculate the total distance. When von Neumann solved the puzzle instantly, the questioner assumed he?d heard the trick before, but in fact he had just summed the infinite series. If you can do that instantly in your head, why bother with the clever trick? For software engineers, the most important kind of raw intelligence is often the size of your working memory: how many moving pieces you can hold in your head at a given time. Software design involves finding elegant ways to reduce that number of moving pieces, typically...

8. The Microsoft building that was reportedly haunted
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 30 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261030-00/?p=112815/
Lots of rumors, little confirmation. The post The Microsoft building that was reportedly haunted appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. College will only cost $20 a month
Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Fri, 30 Oct 2026 23:35:13 GMT
Link: https://idiallo.com/blog/college-will-cost-20-dollars
From 2020 to 2022, I’ve encouraged a steady stream of students to pursue their education in computer science. Tech companies were hiring like crazy. I would interview 3 candidates a week on some occasions. The future of tech seemed to be paved with gold. Any day now, several of those students will graduate. I dread opening my inbox and get an email from them asking: "So... about those jobs?" Things have changed since those crazy old days. Hiring has come to a stop. Those graduates will step into a market that looks nothing like what they signed up for.

Getting a job will be a struggle. If I could see the future, I would have recommended a different path. But then again, how could I have known? Hindsight is always 20/20. So this leaves me with a dilemma as a parent. What do I tell my own kids? Am I going to push them to pursue the same traditional colleges? Will I disburse life savings so they could attend a prestigious university? Or will I just buy them a $20 a month AI Subscription? Imagine handing a student a textbook straight from a university syllabus. They read a lesson, and then you have an AI tutor to quiz them, debate concepts, and break down difficult ideas until they fu...

10. Signing and Attestations Across Package Registries
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-30T10:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/30/signing-and-attestations-across-package-registries.html
Package signing and attestations are two ways of attaching evidence to a published artifact so that someone downloading it later can check where it came from. A signature binds the bytes to a key, either the registry?s or the author?s. A provenance attestation is a signed statement about where an artifact came from, usually in-toto and signed through Sigstore . SLSA build provenance names the source repository, commit and build workflow, while a publish attestation such as PyPI?s records which trusted publisher uploaded the file. Trusted publishing, which several registries have added alongside attestations, replaces long-lived API tokens with short-lived OIDC credentials from CI. It makes provenance easy to produce because the registry receives a verified workflow identity with each upload. Some registries offer trusted publishing on its own. The workflow?s identity becomes the publishing credential, so a compromised workflow can publish a malicious release. GitHub Actions security in Python packages audits those workflows for PyPI. Linux distributions have signed packages for decades. Debian builds binaries from uploaded source on its own buildd machines and Fedora builds throug...

11. Book Review: The God of Small Things by Arundhati Roy ?????
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Fri, 30 Oct 2026 12:34:22 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/book-review-the-god-of-small-things-by-arundhati-roy/
I did not care for this one bit. I found it cloying, infantilising, and far too circuitous. It starts off as a bit of an overwritten melodrama, where every phrase is a delicious flower waiting to bloom, but ends up being a over-sugared mess with a rotten heart. Parts are just exhausting to read, with no time to catch your breath between scenes. That can work in some books when spaced out -?

12. Robert Caro ? The master biographer reflects at 91
Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Fri, 30 Oct 2026 16:56:02 GMT
Link: https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/robert-caro
"A lot of the stuff that I cut out, it’s tragic that no one knows it."

13. This Week on The Analog Antiquarian
Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 30 Oct 2026 17:03:04 +0000
Link: https://www.filfre.net/2026/10/this-week-on-the-analog-antiquarian/
Time Out London (Elizabethan Edition)